



Wandyr

an Adventure Game



Wândyr, an Adventure Game

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About the Name: Wândyr is “wander” as in travel about, but also “wonder” as in finding wondrous things in your travels, and maybe bringing them back.

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Welcome to Wândyr!

Wândyr is an adventure game about a band of adventurers wandering through a pulp fantasy world. The focus is on exploration, following rumors, discovering new places, finding magic, treasure hunting, camping, singing, storytelling, cleverly overcoming impossible odds, and coming back alive with tales to tell. In the spirit of *The Hobbit*, Wândyr celebrates the journey of going there and back again.

The stories and songs of your characters emerge during play, filled with wonder and surprises that even the Guide doesn't anticipate.

Sandbox

The Guide describes the world but doesn't create a story beforehand. The local area remains wide open and undefined, even if some aspects of the wider world are known. This "sandbox" style allows everyone at the table to discover the unexpected together.

The Guide uses dice rolls and random tables to determine what happens rather than telling a predetermined story. Each new discovery adds to the growing lore of your campaign world.



The Oracle

The **Oracle** answers any yes/no question instantly, often adding unexpected "sweet" or "spicy" flavor to keep adventures surprising. Both Guide and players consult the Oracle during play.

For deeper questions, the Oracle excels at "20 questions" to reveal mysteries piece by piece. The Guide should also use the random tables in the **Wândyr World Oracle**.

Wândyr is compatible with most Old School Roleplaying (OSR) games, but with fresh mechanics. Thus, the Guide has a wealth of material to augment the Oracle.

Starting a Game

Wândyr is a game played with friends. Select one person to be the Guide; the other people are players.

1 - Starting Location

The Guide describes the starting location for the adventure, such as a medieval tavern in a town on the borderlands. The Guide can place this into a larger fantasy world, or let that be a mystery for now.

2 - Create Characters

Each player needs three characters. A character has two Traits and two Skills, for example:

LINDON: BRAVE, STRONG | POLEAX, ARMOR



2 - Select a Rumor

The Guide then lists a few rumors that hint about troublesome events in the area or interesting places to explore. The players choose a rumor to follow.

3 - Muster a Character

Each player rolls 2d6 Hearts for each of their characters and chooses one to "Muster" (play). From now on, each player becomes their mustered character. The Guide gives new characters 1-4 basic "hand me down" items for weapons, armor, tools, spellbooks, etc.

4 - Pack for the Journey

The Guide should provide a landmark or general directions so the path of the journey is clear, and provide or suggest basic travel supplies (e.g. food, water, traveling cloak). Players can swap items amongst themselves, but must leave unnecessary items behind with their other characters.

5 - Embark

Start play on the road. Each player plays their mustered character; the Guide handles everything else.



Character Creation

Characters start with two Traits and two Skills. Use your own words, but keep it clear and simple. Example:

ROOK: AGILE, CUNNING | KNIFE, (LOCKPICKS)

"Rook" is "agile" and "cunning" (Traits). Rook knows how to use a knife and *secretly lockpicks* (Skills).

Traits

A Trait is a keyword that describes a personal quality, talent, or background. Examples: agile, bold, strong, tough, intelligent, clever, sneaky. A Trait must be a single word, or a common compound word like *man-at-arms*, *horse-thief*, *second-story-man*, or *witch-hunter*.

Skills

A Skill is an item proficiency. Examples: dagger, longsword, bow, lockpicks, shield, armor, type of animal, spellbook, wand, arcane staff, etc. Skills can be broad or narrow, but broad skills just cover the most basic items of that kind, so "sword" does not provide skill in a

specialized sword type such as "greatsword".

Magic Traits

A Trait related to magic costs one Skill. For example, a magic-user taking Trait for their magic school has one less Skill.

VESPER: SCHOLAR "ILLUSIONE" | SPELLBOOK

HEZEREK: AMBITIOUS "UMBRAKALLA" | ORB

TALIN: HALLOW "VITAE" | ROD

New Characters

Characters start as unproven, untested novices with no prior experience or heroic deeds. *All this must develop during the game.*

Players may describe their appearance; this might derive from their upbringing, homeland, or ancestry (human, elf, dwarf, etc.). A character's appearance might affect how NPCs perceive the character, but not game mechanics.

The Guide will provide 1-4 "hand me down" items to new characters when they first Muster. This is inferred by their Traits and Skills.

Example Characters

Choose or roll d66, or mix n' match parts.

ALIAS: TRAITS | SKILLS

1.1 ROOK: AGILE, CUNNING | KNIFE, (LOCKPICKS)

1.2 CIPHER: CALCULATING, (ELUSIVE) | CIPHERS,
DAGGERS

1.3 SHADOW: SILENT, (RUTHLESS) | BLOWGUN,
POISONS

1.4 WILDE: CHARMING, (DECEPTIVE) | CARDS,
CUTLASS

1.5 LYRA: NIMBLE, (SPY) | DAGGER, ROPE

1.6 PEARL: NOBLE, (DEADLY) | DISGUISE KIT,
(STILETTO)

2.1 SERRA: FIERCE, DISCIPLINED | BATTLE AX,
SHIELD

2.2 MAGNUS: STRONG, BOISTEROUS | WARHAMMER,
ARMOR

2.3 IRON: TOUGH, HARD | HAMMER, TONGS

2.4 SARGE: GRIZZLED, SOLDIER | ARMING SWORD,
ARMOR

2.5 PIKE: GUARD, ALERT | HALBERD, WHISTLE

2.6 SHIRO: HONORABLE, LETHAL | KATANA,
WAKIZASHI

3.1 DRAKE: WEATHERED, RESOURCEFUL | MACHETE,
TINDERBOX

3.2 SLATE: SCOUT, OBSERVANT | TELESCOPE, BOW

3.3 WOLF: FERAL, INSTINCTIVE | SPEAR, FURS

3.4 HAWK: KEEN, VIGILANT | LONGBOW,
FALCONRY-GLOVE

3.5 STORM: IMPETUOUS, DARING | JAVELIN,
GRAPNEL

3.6 ECHO: HALLOW, "VITAE" | HARP

4.1 KAT: CLIMBING, (THIEVERY) | GRAPPLING HOOK,
(THIEVES TOOLS)

4.2 FORGE: ARMORER, STEADFAST | HAMMER,
SHIELD

4.3 QUILL: METICULOUS, LEARNED | LEDGER, INKWELL

4.4 FLINT: STEELY, HARDY | AXE, COOKPOT

4.5 NAILS: TOUGH, HARSH | FLAIL, GAMBESON

4.6 LINDON: BRAVE, STRONG | POLEAX, ARMOR

5.1 KHAEL: WITCH-HUNTER "UMBRAKALLA" |
BINDING CHAINS

5.2 VESPER: SCHOLAR "ILLUSIONE" | STAFF

5.3 TWILIGHT: DEVIOUS "NECROMANTIA" | SICKLE

5.4 ISTAR: WHITE-WIZARD "VITAE" | STAFF

5.5 HEZEREK, AMBITIOUS "UMBRAKALLA" | ORB

5.6 IGNUS: FIERY "ELEMENTALE" | STAFF

6.1 DUSK: HONORABLE, (EXILED) | ANCESTRAL
BLADE, DOUBLET

6.2 OAK: STRONG, ENDURING | STAFF, ROPE

6.3 VALE: WOODCRAFT HUNTER | LONGBOW, KNIFE

6.4 DIGS: DOUR, MINING | PICKAXE, MINING HELMET

6.5 BEAR: STRONG, PROTECTIVE | MAUL, BEARSKIN
CLOAK

6.6 THALIA: HALLOW, KEEN-EYED | BOW, SWORD

The Muster

Ok boys, check your kit, check your weapons, it's today. You get a pint and a chaser, no more. Let's go.

During the Muster, each player takes on the role of one character adventuring today. The Guide provides new characters with 1-4 basic "hand me down" items.

Hearts

Players roll 2d6 Hearts for each of their three characters, and choose one who answers the Muster and will be played today.

10 Item Slots

Each character has 10 Item Slots to hold gear they have "equipped" and can access and use easily.

Each slot can hold one small item (cloak, flask, tinderbox, flask, 1 day rations, torch, coin purse, arrow quiver, lockpicks) or a bundle of tiny identical items (bowstrings, gems).

Larger items use 1-4 Item Slots:

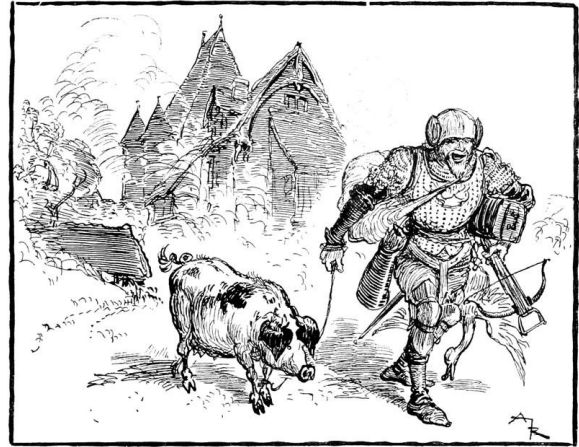
- ❖ **Weapons:** dagger 1, sword 2, halberd 3, pike 4
- ❖ **Bows:** arrow quiver 1, bow 2, crossbow 3, arbalest 4
- ❖ **Shields:** buckler 1, heater 2, round shield 3, tower shield 4
- ❖ **Armor:** gauntlets 1, helm 2, gambeson 3, haubergeon 4
- ❖ **Musical Instrument:** pipe 1, lute 2, guitar 3, war drums 4

Baggage

Characters can carry gear outside of their 10 Item Slots but must keep a separate list called "Baggage" (big bags or rucksacks). Accessing an item from Baggage takes d6 Turns. Baggage halves movement and causes safety issues when swimming, leaping, climbing, etc.

Home Base

The characters are part of an "adventuring party" with a "home base". Party Level adds to Hearts when Mustering from "home base", but it starts at level zero. *They might be an adventurers guild, warband, canting crew, etc. Their base could be a tavern, flat house, hideout, etc.*



Camping

In Wāndyr, each game starts with a Muster and ends in Camp. When the adventuring party decides to stop and rest, they must choose whether to make a temporary camp or return home.

Downtime

Camping is downtime. Each character exits play until the next time they Muster. The game is essentially “paused”, allowing the players and Guide to openly and rapidly discuss topics that might be more difficult to do when actively playing a character. For example, at this time the Guide awards XP and players can spend XP. The party may also fast-forward in time.

Comforts

The comforts of home are cheerful companions. A wheel of cheese, a crusty bread, mead, wine, or a good smoke can make even the most dismal dungeon feel fine.

A character who consumes a Comfort during Muster receives up to 2 extra Hearts. A 1-Heart comfort is 10 gp and uses 1 slot; a 2-Heart is 100 gp and 2 slots. Comforts are available in taverns, inns, and provisioners.

Experience

The Guide awards XP in Camp. Characters can earn 1-6 XP for

following their selected rumor to its full conclusion. They can also earn 1 XP by discovering an important new location or magical feature, map a new region, or rescue captives. *Slaying monsters and taking treasure does not directly earn XP.*

Characters can learn new Traits and Skills while in camp. This costs XP equal to the current count of that item type (minimum 1 XP). So the 3rd Trait is 3 xp. Characters can also spend XP on Names (see below).

Party Level

The adventuring party has a Party Level, which starts at zero but can grow over time. Party Level grants extra Hearts when mustering from “home base” and is used by the Guide to set the Oracle target.

Characters can advance their Party Level to Level 1 by paying 2,000 gp; the cost doubles for each Level. *The gold is presumed spent on improvements to “home base”, hiring trainers, throwing parties, etc.*

Game Play

The game mostly consists of a conversation around the table, where people take turns to ask questions and attempt actions.

Facts

When a player asks a question about a *fact* yet unknown, the Guide asks the Oracle for truth:

- "Is this town on a waterway?"
- "Is there a trail in the woods?"
- "Do they seem friendly?"

Actions

When a player takes an action, they ask the Oracle for the result:

- "I flee and climb a tree!"
- "I throw my spear"
- "I parry with my shield!"

Conversations may resemble a game of "20 questions"; the answer will be a surprise to everyone.

Ask the Oracle

Speak a question such as "does my spear hit the foe?" and roll 2d6: if the total is 8 or higher the answer is "Yes", otherwise "No".

Advantage/Disadvantage

With Advantage, roll 3d6 and keep the two best dice; on Disadvantage roll 3d6 and keep the two worst. Never remove a 1 from the roll (e.g. 1, 1, 6 = 8 and 1, 6, 6 = 13).

A character can have Advantage with clever planning or **Insight**.

Disadvantages may apply for poor positioning, unarmed, in bad terrain, poor visibility, using a bow in close

combat, etc. Advantage cancels Disadvantage, simply roll 2d6.

Easy / Hard

The Guide sets the Oracle target number as easy (6), normal (8), hard (10), or extreme (12). When possible, the Guide should compare Party Level with the Level of an opponent, monster, or challenge.

Sweet and Spicy

When any die rolls a 6, the outcome is "Sweet," adding a stylistic flair. Double 6s indicate a bonus or benefit. Conversely, if any die rolls a 1, the outcome is "Spicy," also adding style. Double 1s signify a penalty or complication.

Example: Bowman snipes a sentry. A "spicy" result might mean another guard notices, while a "sweet" result could mean the guard's uniform is spotless.

The Guide can either describe these effects or allow the player to provide their own interpretation. Unless the side effect is straightforward and very minor, ask the Oracle if it happens. Players must spend a Heart to request a heroic stunt or a magical effect.

Turns

The game uses Turns so each player has a chance to speak. A Turn is the amount of time needed for each player to move and take an action or ask a question. The amount of time depends on context: from days of travel to a few seconds in combat.

Turn Clock

The Guide marks the passage of time on the "Turn Clock". A metal bowl and glass beads or other tokens is ideal. Advance the Clock by 1 at the start of each Turn or whenever the players do something time-consuming. Roll Insight at the same time. When the Clock would strike 7 the Guide clears the Clock and restarts at 1. *Perhaps a random encounter or event will occur?*

Names

Characters can earn Names in play, such as epithets, songs, and spells.

Once earned, the character can pay XP to take the Name. The player records the Name as a byname, or on a list of Names (songs, stories, spells) along with its Level, which its power tier and XP cost. The character may alternatively *Name an item* (see Named Items).

Using Names

Names are helpful for Insight and may influence NPCs. The character can also invoke a Name to reenact the heroic feat where they earned the Name; each attempt costs its Level in Hearts. This may sound simple but is quite significant!

Named Items

A **Named Item** has at least one Name (and at most one per item slot). If kept equipped at all times, the character may use each Name once per Muster, at no Hearts cost. Characters may hire an artisan to inscribe items with their Names and decorations (inlays, etchings, gems, gold leaf, etc.), creating a legacy.



Music

Music is important because it makes everything better. A character can perform once per Muster for each music instrument **Skill** and song

Name. A performance takes at least 10 minutes and can influence NPC reactions or raise party morale. Each performance reaches an audience size up to the song Name Level plus the musical instrument item slots. Quality instruments may have a “plus” bonus such as a “guitar +1”. If the Oracle agrees, each person in the audience is *restored 1* Heart (i.e. not to exceed Hearts at Muster). Group performances are more fun and reach more listeners.

Magic

Wândyr is full of magic, and much of the game is about exploring and meddling with magical secrets.

All magic in Wândyr involves *True Names*, either written or spoken as words of power. A True Name can provide a magic enhancement to an item, a sorcery to bind a spirit into a “sentient” item, a sigil for a magic-user spell, and much more.

All magic items and magical objects bear mystical inscriptions: sharp dwarven runes, flowing elven script, or shifting arcane glyphs. Only those versed in magic can decipher these writings to identify the magic effects and method of wielding the magic.

Magic Items

Most magic items function as their mundane counterparts plus a magical enhancement. Elven boots silence footsteps, a hero's belt bestows strength, and a “shield +1” is extra protective. This often grants a Trait or Skill. Anyone with an appropriate Skill may discover their function through use (i.e. the qualities may be overlooked by the unskilled) and some items even require a Skill.

Spell Names

Spells can be found written in spellbooks and on Arcana; they are only usable by magic-users.



Sentient Items

Sentient items contain a bound soul of a magic-user, elemental, *d'jinn*, *ifr'it*, *kha'din*, dragon, eldar, deep one, or other entity. Bound spirits are notoriously capricious, jealous, and unhinged from confinement, their original dreams and ambitions maybe twisted by madness.

Sentient items are temperamental; when a character first attempts to use one, ask the Oracle if the item *accepts* them. On Sweet or Spicy, the item also talks to them!

A character who carries a sentient item grows in *alignment* and may discover deeper mysteries. They might take a personal Name such as "Wielder of Duskbringer". It's petty, but they *hate* anyone who offends their fragile egos, such as carrying them after being rejected, refusing to follow their agenda, abandoning, or "cheating" on them with a rival item.

Magic-Users

Magic is classified by "school", such as Vitae (life), Elemental, Thaumaturgy (control), Illusione (illusions & mental), Umbrakala (shadows & gates), or Necromantia.

A character with a Trait for a **Magic School** is a "magic-user" of that school, literate in its otherwise secret arcane magic language. All

words are magical to a degree, and all true magic is made of words, runes, glyphs, or arcane script.

Spellbooks

A spellbook is an item using 1-4 item slots, with one spell per slot.

Spell Casting

Casting a spell requires an item with the spell Name such as a Spellbook or Arcana. A magic-user who has learned the spell Name no longer needs an item.

The magic-user needs at least one free hand and must say the magic power words loudly and precisely.

Upon casting a spell, the magic-user loses Hearts equal to the Spell Level. Consuming a *Magic Component* reduces the cost by 1 Heart per item slot (max one component per spell). Magic components can be found in strange magical places.



Magic Oracle

The player must always ask the Oracle if the spell casting outcome matches their *intention*. On “NO” *something unintended* happens (Sweet is close but flawed and Spicy is wildly different or dangerous) Ask the Oracle a question or two about what happened, and add to Lore.

Spell Duration

Instant spells are one-shot, instantaneous effects.

Active spells last for the current encounter (e.g. a combat or scene). When the Turn Clock clears, Active

spells expire unless the encounter is still going strong.

Spell are True Names

Magic-users may learn spells as **Names** by paying the spell Level in XP, and then they no longer need an item to cast the spell.

A magic-user can only take a spell Name after they have cast it from a spellbook with *Sweet*. Upon taking the Name it vanishes from the spellbook, leaving just a fragment.

The magic-user may alternatively choose to enchant the spell Name into an item, creating an **Arcana**.

Arcana

An Arcana is an item with one or more True Names of spell written on it. Arcana can be any kind of item (even tattoos) and have magic-user “drip” based on their spell Names,

If kept equipped at all times, a magic-user can use each Name in an Arcana once per Muster, at no Hearts cost if the Arcana and magic effect are ostentatiously *visible*.

If a weapon is an Arcana the magic-user can cast one of its spells on a “hit” instead of damage.



Magic-User Spell Lists

1 Vitae (Life)

Life force, growth, and harmony. The magic of the Elves, written in living ink that grows and changes like vines. The hallow channel beneficial energies, promote growth, and keep nature's balance.

- 1.1.1** *Animal Bond* - Form lasting connection
- 1.1.2** *Animal Friendship* - Benevolent control
- 1.1.3** *Balance Weave* - Unite opposites
- 1.1.4** *Beast Bond* - Create long-lasting bond
- 1.1.5** *Beast Form* - Friendly transformation
- 1.1.6** *Beast Speech* - Talk with animals

- 1.2.1** *Divine Grace* - Channel blessing
- 1.2.2** *Healing Touch* - Cure wounds
- 1.2.3** *Joy Song* - Lift spirits
- 1.2.4** *Life Bloom* - Encourage growth
- 1.2.5** *Light Shield* - Protect from evil
- 1.2.6** *Pacify* - Remove violence

- 1.3.1** *Peace Aura* - Calm violence
- 1.3.2** *Snail Knight* - Summon noble mount
- 1.3.3** *Star Guide* - Find true path
- 1.3.4** *Sun Beam* - Channel daylight
- 1.3.5** *Thicket* - Grow healthy plants
- 1.3.6** *Truth Sight* - See through lies

- 1.4.1** *Ward* - Create protective barrier
- 1.4.2** *Cure Disease* - Remove ailments
- 1.4.3** *Forest Touch* - Speak with plants
- 1.4.4** *Growing Script* - Living magical writing
- 1.4.5** *Nature's Blessing* - Enhance vitality
- 1.4.6** *Purification* - Remove toxins

- 1.5.1** *Regeneration* - Speed natural healing
- 1.5.2** *Heart Glyph* - Inscribe emotions
- 1.5.3** *Nature's Bounty* - Create food/water
- 1.5.4** *Pack Call* - Summon animal allies
- 1.5.5** *Vital Surge* - Boost life force
- 1.5.6** *Wild Empathy* - Share animal feelings

- 1.6.1** *Life Transfer* - Share vital force
- 1.6.2** *Nature's Rhythm* - Align with cycles
- 1.6.3** *Perfect Unity* - Complete balance
- 1.6.4** *Season's Call* - Control growth cycle
- 1.6.5** *Tranquil Heart* - Create inner peace
- 1.6.6** *Vital Harmony* - Balance life forces

2 Elemental (Elemental)

Primal forces, elements, and weather. The Baal inscribe dragon magic in burning runes carved in stone. Practitioners control weather, create barriers of ice and fire, command gravity, and shape elements.

- 2.1.1** *Control Weather* - Command climate
- 2.1.2** *Crystal Growth* - Form gems
- 2.1.3** *Dragon's Breath* - Channel flame
- 2.1.4** *Earth Shape* - Mold stone
- 2.1.5** *Earthquake* - Shake ground
- 2.1.6** *Element Master* - Complete control

- 2.2.1** *Elemental Wall* - Create barrier
- 2.2.2** *Fire Shield* - Protective flames
- 2.2.3** *Fog Cloud* - Create mist
- 2.2.4** *Force Wall* - Energy barrier
- 2.2.5** *Gravity Shift* - Change gravity
- 2.2.6** *Heat Metal* - Make objects burning

- 2.3.1** *Icy Touch* - Spread ice
- 2.3.2** *Increase Gravity* - Triple weight
- 2.3.3** *Lightning Strike* - Call electricity
- 2.3.4** *Liquid Air* - Make air swimmable
- 2.3.5** *Mist Form* - Become vapor
- 2.3.6** *Mountain's Strength* - Earth power

- 2.4.1** *Rain Make* - Create downpour
- 2.4.2** *Sculpt Elements* - Shape materials
- 2.4.3** *Steam Form* - Become vapor
- 2.4.4** *Stone Skin* - Harden flesh
- 2.4.5** *Stone Tell* - Read earth memories
- 2.4.6** *Storm Call* - Summon thunder

- 2.5.1** *Summon Cube* - Control earth
- 2.5.2** *Summon Idol* - Create statue
- 2.5.3** *Thunder Call* - Create sonic boom
- 2.5.4** *Tide Control* - Command waters
- 2.5.5** *Upwell* - Create spring
- 2.5.6** *Water Breathing* - Breathe liquid

- 2.6.1** *Water Shape* - Control liquid
- 2.6.2** *Web Weave* - Spin natural nets
- 2.6.3** *Whirlwind* - Create vortex
- 2.6.4** *Wind Shield* - Air protection
- 2.6.5** *Wind Walk* - Float on breeze
- 2.6.6** *Zephyr* - Ride the winds

3 Thaumaturgy (Control)

Physical laws, mechanisms, and force. The engineering magic of the Dwur, written in foundational runes that command reality. Practitioners control objects, manipulate energy, bind powers, and impose their will upon matter.

3.1.1 *Adhere* - Make sticky

3.1.2 *Animate Object* - Objects obey

3.1.3 *Astral Prison* - Crystal stasis

3.1.4 *Command* - Force obedience

3.1.5 *Elasticity* - Control form

3.1.6 *Filch* - Teleport items

3.2.1 *Force Push* - Directional power

3.2.2 *Haste* - Control speed

3.2.3 *Hover* - Control levitation

3.2.4 *Invisible Tether* - Bind objects

3.2.5 *Knock* - Open locks

3.2.6 *Leap* - Control jumping

3.3.1 *Lock* - Seal door

3.3.2 *Magic Suppressor* - Null magic

3.3.3 *Masterscript* - Write command runes

3.3.4 *Shrink Item* - Reduce size

3.3.5 *Sort* - Organize items

3.3.6 *Spider Climb* - Control climbing

3.4.1 *Strengthen* - Reinforce material

3.4.2 *Teleport* - Move objects

3.4.3 *Time Slip* - Control time

3.4.4 *Unravel* - Counter spells

3.4.5 *Augment Object* - Enhance item

3.4.6 *Control Device* - Command mechanisms

3.5.1 *Animate Tool* - Give purpose

3.5.2 *Binding Circle* - Contain force

3.5.3 *Density Control* - Alter mass

3.5.4 *Enhance Power* - Boost magic

3.5.5 *Mend* - Repair objects

3.5.6 *Object Memory* - Read item history

3.6.1 *Reality Anchor* - Stabilize space

3.6.2 *Rune Lock* - Seal with power

3.6.3 *Shape Material* - Change form

3.6.4 *Magic Circle* - Create workspace

3.6.5 *Thaumaturgic Seal* - Master rune

3.6.6 *Perfect Control* - Complete mastery

4 Illusione (Illusion)

Perception, thought, and dreams. The subtle magic of the Belerions, woven from phantasmal scripts that deceive the senses. Illusionists create illusions, alter memories, influence minds, and bend perceived reality.

4.1.1 *Arcane Eye* - Flying sensor

4.1.2 *Auditory Illusion* - Create sounds

4.1.3 *Bewitch* - Enchant mind

4.1.4 *Blur* - Distort appearance

4.1.5 *Charm* - Create friendship

4.1.6 *Detect Magic* - See magic

4.2.1 *Disguise* - Alter appearance

4.2.2 *Dream Message* - Send sleeping visions

4.2.3 *Dream Walking* - Enter dreams

4.2.4 *Duplicate* - Create copies

4.2.5 *Emotional Aura* - Project feeling

4.2.6 *False Memory* - Plant fake memory

4.3.1 *Feign Death* - Appear dead

4.3.2 *Greed* - Create obsession

4.3.3 *Hypnotize* - Question trance

4.3.4 *Illusory Spray* - Disorient with light

4.3.5 *Invisibility* - Become unseen

4.3.6 *Mass Suggestion* - Group command

4.4.1 *Major Image* - Perfect illusion

4.4.2 *Mind Maze* - Trap thoughts

4.4.3 *Mind Shield* - Protect thoughts

4.4.4 *Mirror Image* - Create duplicates

4.4.5 *Mirror Walk* - Step through glass

4.4.6 *Perfect Illusion* - Undetectable fake

4.5.1 *Phantom Sound* - Distant noise

4.5.2 *Phantasmal Force* - Moving illusion

4.5.3 *Programmed Illusion* - Triggered effect

4.5.4 *Read Mind* - Hear thoughts

4.5.5 *Scry* - Share vision

4.5.6 *Silent Image* - Create scene

4.6.1 *Spectacle* - Create grand illusion

4.6.2 *Telepathy* - Project thoughts

4.6.3 *True Seeing* - Pierce deception

4.6.4 *Vision* - Personal illusion

4.6.5 *Visual Illusion* - Static images

4.6.6 *X-Ray Vision* - See through matter

5 Umbrakallo (Shadow Gates)

Shadows, thresholds, and dimensional paths. The secret magic of the Alu, written in darkness and void. Practitioners create Kalla gates, walk between shadows, craft dimensional spaces, and traverse the boundaries between realms.

- 5.1.1** *Befuddle* - Shadow memories
- 5.1.2** *Body Swap* - Shadow exchange
- 5.1.3** *Cloak of Shadows* - Dark protection
- 5.1.4** *Dark Anchor* - Fix dimensional point
- 5.1.5** *Darksight* - See in darkness
- 5.1.6** *Deep Shadow* - Create pure darkness

- 5.2.1** *Dimension Door* - Create portal
- 5.2.2** *Disassemble* - Shadow-split form
- 5.2.3** *Gate Sense* - Detect portals
- 5.2.4** *Hatred* - Dark emotion
- 5.2.5** *Ice Heart* - Freeze with shadow
- 5.2.6** *Kalla Gate* - Create pocket realm

- 5.3.1** *Kallascript* - Write gate runes
- 5.3.2** *Masquerade* - Shadow dance
- 5.3.3** *Miniaturize* - Shrink into shadows
- 5.3.4** *Mind Shatter* - Shadow thoughts
- 5.3.5** *Night Sphere* - Create darkness
- 5.3.6** *Nightmare Seed* - Dark dreams

- 5.4.1** *Ooze Form* - Shadow substance
- 5.4.2** *Phantom Coach* - Shadow transport
- 5.4.3** *Plane Shift* - Change reality
- 5.4.4** *Realm Weave* - Connect spaces
- 5.4.5** *Shadow Bind* - Trap in darkness
- 5.4.6** *Shadow Clone* - Create dark duplicate

- 5.5.1** *Shadow Meld* - Merge with darkness
- 5.5.2** *Shadow Step* - Travel through dark
- 5.5.3** *Shadow Time* - Pause in darkness
- 5.5.4** *Shuffle* - Shadow displacement
- 5.5.5** *Smoke Form* - Become shadow
- 5.5.6** *Space Fold* - Bend dimensions

- 5.6.1** *Threshold Walk* - Pass through doors
- 5.6.2** *Twilight Veil* - Walk between worlds
- 5.6.3** *Void Gate* - Open dark portal
- 5.6.4** *Void Shield* - Dark protection
- 5.6.5** *Void Step* - Brief teleport
- 5.6.6** *Perfect Shadow* - Complete control

6 Necromantia (Death)

Death, spirits, and decay. The forbidden magic of the Avathars, inscribed in blood and bone. Practitioners bind spirits, animate dead, drain life force, and manipulate the boundary between life and death.

- 6.1.1** *Animate Skeleton* - Raise bones
- 6.1.2** *Black Sacrament* - Death ritual
- 6.1.3** *Blood Curse* - Sacrifice life
- 6.1.4** *Blood Track* - Follow wounds
- 6.1.5** *Bone Puppet* - Animate dead
- 6.1.6** *Bone Shield* - Skeletal armor

- 6.2.1** *Command Undead* - Control dead
- 6.2.2** *Comprehend Dead* - Dead languages
- 6.2.3** *Corpse Explosion* - Detonate dead
- 6.2.4** *Dark Blessing* - Death's power
- 6.2.5** *Death Gate* - Portal to underworld
- 6.2.6** *Death Touch* - Wither life

- 6.3.1** *Death Ward* - Protect from necrotic
- 6.3.2** *Doom Mark* - Mark for death
- 6.3.3** *Drain Life* - Steal vitality
- 6.3.4** *Fear Aura* - Death terror
- 6.3.5** *Ghost Bind* - Trap spirits
- 6.3.6** *Grave Mist* - Create death fog

- 6.4.1** *Life Sense* - Detect living
- 6.4.2** *Mass Animation* - Raise army
- 6.4.3** *Marble Madness* - Death's toys
- 6.4.4** *Pain Echo* - Share suffering
- 6.4.5** *Plague Wind* - Spread death
- 6.4.6** *Psychometry* - Read death echoes

- 6.5.1** *Raise Dead* - Create undead
- 6.5.2** *Sniff* - Smell death
- 6.5.3** *Soul Cage* - Trap essence
- 6.5.4** *Soul Rend* - Tear spirit
- 6.5.5** *Speak with Dead* - Question spirits
- 6.5.6** *Spirit Chains* - Bind ghost

- 6.6.1** *Spirit Form* - Become ghostly
- 6.6.2** *Truth Sense* - Death's truth
- 6.6.3** *Undead Sight* - See spirits
- 6.6.4** *Vampiric Touch* - Drain energy
- 6.6.5** *Wizard Mark* - Death runes
- 6.6.6** *Perfect Death* - Ultimate end

Invocations

Otherworldly beings can be called on by speaking their *True Names*.

Lore

When the name of an otherworldly being is first found, randomly generate it. The players may also ask the Oracle questions such as “have we heard of this being before?” or “is this being aligned with Law?”. Anything learned becomes part of the known Lore of the True Name, which can help shape future interactions.

Invocations

A character can make an Invocation by loudly and formally calling the True Name *thrice* and making a request.

The player rolls the Oracle to ask if the request is fulfilled. On Sweet the being *likes* the request, and on Spicy they *dislike* it. The character loses d6 Hearts (half on Sweet, double on Spicy). If they run out of Hearts something weird happens.

If the Oracle says the request is fulfilled, the Guide follows existing Lore and asks the Oracle how that plays out. Character alignment to the True Name matters.

Alignment

After an Invocation, the character must offer d6 XP and ask the Oracle how they are spent.

Relics

Relics are objects with connections to otherworldly beings. They are conduits for alignment, and have even been known to make Invocations or whisper mystical secrets. Relics are often mistaken for “cursed” magic items.

Monsters

Each monster (or trap, etc.) has a **Level** comparable to **Party Level**. The Oracle is “hard” if this is higher than Party Level; or “easy” if lower.

Level 0: giant rat, vermin, goblin
Level 1: orc, skeleton, deathskito
Level 2: zombie, ghoul, giant ant, slime
Level 3: wight, harpy, giant spider
Level 4: werewolf, ogre, huge slime
Level 5: mummy, minotaur, owlbeast
Level 6: troll, wyvern, spectre, manticores
Level 7: griffon, djinni, vampire
Level 9: chimera, giant
Level 10: golem, dragon

For more detail, the Guide can use OSR monsters or wing it as follows.

Weak pack/tribal monsters have d6 Hearts; leaders 2d6. A solitary “apex predator” monster has 2d6 or 3d6 Hearts per HD, multiple attacks, plus a deadly attack of 2d6 or 3d6, or d6 Hearts per Turn for HD+2 Turns (for paralysis, poison, petrification, etc).

Fighting

In each Turn, a character can Move and Attack (or take another action).

Move

A character can stand up OR move 40' (40 feet). Each impediment (e.g. Baggage, readying weapons, bad terrain, darkness) cuts this in half.

Attack

When a character attacks, ask the Oracle if they "hit". Each "hit" deals d6 Hearts. More lethal weapons may have a "plus" bonus, e.g. "greatsword +1". Attackers are open to counterattacks.

Defend

When a character is attacked or otherwise endangered, ask the Oracle if they avoid getting "hit". Armor and shields provide 1 "iron" Heart per item slot, usable vs weapons. More protective armor may have a "plus" bonus, such as "shield +1".

Initiative

The Guide determines the "initiative order" in which characters and monsters take their turns. Attacks and counter attacks are often simultaneous.

However, when enemies approach from a distance, the weapon with the better reach (by item slots) has the "right of way" to attack first.

In close quarters combat (less than 10 feet of fighting space) the smaller weapon is better.

Melee

A character is "in Melee" if they are within reach (~10 feet) of an enemy who is making a melee attack. The character has Disadvantage on all rolls unless they attempt an attack with a close combat weapon (e.g. dagger, sword, spear, pistol).

Hearts

Hearts act as plot armor; a character is not injured while they have Hearts. A character at 0 Hearts is injured but can recover in Camp. A character below 0 Hearts is *dying* and needs magic healing; when the Turn Clock clears, anyone below 0 Hearts immediately dies.



Saving Throws

When someone is exposed to a special effect (poison, petrification, breath, magic, paralyzation, etc.), ask the Oracle if they somehow avoid the "worst half" of the effect. On YES they take half the effect.

The Oracle

Ask a question and roll 2d6: if the total is 8 or higher the answer is "Yes", otherwise "No".

Always phrase the question for yes/no where the characters *want* to hear "Yes":

- "Do we find shelter?"
- "Is the sword magical?"
- "Do I hit the monster?"
- "Do I avoid the trap?"

Sweet & Spicy

If any die rolls 6 the answer is "Sweet", and if any die rolls a 1 the answer is "Spicy". The player asks a question on Sweet; the Guide asks a question on Spicy.

The Oracle also knows how to play 20 questions.



Insight

Insight is an opportunity to claim advantage. Players who follow Insight on a roll have Advantage. Roll d6 for Insight each Turn.

1 - TRAIT

Use a helpful Trait. Strong helps open stuck doors or crack heads.

2 - ITEM

Use a helpful item. (Special items require a specialized item Skill, e.g. longbow, lockpicks, greatsword, spellbooks, wand, etc.)

3 - SKILL

Use a helpful item Skill; requires the item.

4 - NAME

Use a relevant Name (personal name, byname, title, or named item). "Dragon Slayer" helps with dragon stuff.

5 - ASSIST

Use an Action previously taken that "sets up" or "assists" the current roll. A "parry" helps defend. Characters can assist each other if they sequence their actions.

6 - EFFORT

Apply more effort. Thus, not possible if carrying Baggage, making something look easy, maintaining stealth or subtlety, climbing, swimming, wrestling, etc.